# Riz 3a Djeij

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

*A generous platter of spiced rice, tender chicken and golden nuts always feels like an invitation to gather.*

Serves 6–8 · Prep 25 min · Cook 50 min

## INGREDIENTS

### FOR THE CHICKEN AND BROTH

- 1 kg chicken breasts
- 1 large onion, quartered
- 3 bay leaves
- 2 cinnamon sticks
- 5 cardamom pods, lightly crushed
- Approximately 2 litres water or chicken broth, enough to cover the chicken
- 1 tsp salt, adjusted according to the broth
- ½ tsp black pepper

### FOR THE SPICED RICE

- 500 g ground beef
- 3 cups basmati rice
- 1 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tsp Lebanese seven-spice
- ½ tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp black pepper
- Salt, to taste
- Reserved chicken broth, in the quantity recommended on the rice packet

### FOR THE NUT TOPPING

- 1 tbsp butter
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- ¼ cup almond flakes
- ¼ cup pine nuts
- ¼ cup cashew nuts
- ¼ cup shelled pistachios

## METHOD

1. Cook the chicken. Place the chicken breasts, onion, bay leaves, cinnamon sticks and cardamom in a saucepan. Add enough water or broth to cover, followed by the salt and black pepper. Bring gently to a simmer, skimming off any foam. Cover partially and poach over low heat for approximately 15–25 minutes, depending on the size of the breasts, until cooked through.
2. Transfer the chicken to a plate and cover with a little broth to keep it moist. Strain the remaining broth, discarding the onion and whole spices. Keep the broth hot.
3. Prepare the rice. Rinse the basmati rice until the water runs mostly clear, then drain thoroughly.
4. Brown the beef. Heat the butter and olive oil in a large, heavy saucepan over medium-high heat. Add the ground beef and cook, breaking it up with a spoon, until browned.
5. Stir in the ground cinnamon, seven-spice, cumin and black pepper. Cook briefly until fragrant, then add the drained rice and stir gently to coat.
6. Cook the rice. Measure the hot reserved broth according to the rice packet's liquid ratio. Add to the pan, taste the liquid and adjust the salt. Bring to a gentle boil, cover and reduce the heat to low. Cook according to the packet instructions, until the rice is tender and the liquid has been absorbed.
7. Remove from the heat and leave covered for 10 minutes, then fluff gently with a fork.
8. Prepare the nuts. Meanwhile, heat the butter and olive oil for the topping in a frying pan over medium-low heat. Toast the nuts in separate batches so each kind colours evenly. Lift them out as soon as they turn lightly golden.
9. Assemble the platter. Pull the chicken into generous pieces and warm gently in a little reserved broth if needed. Spoon the spiced beef rice onto a wide platter, arrange the chicken over the top and finish with the golden nuts. Serve hot.

### Tip

Poach the chicken gently. A quiet simmer helps keep the breast meat tender.